ARTICLE 25. To see if the Town will vote, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, to act on the report of the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation (WCCP) to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund the sum of $920,500 to the following projects:

1. Leonard Pavillion Upgrade and Restoration
2. Lincoln School Shade Structure
3. McDonald Tennis Court Resurfacing
4. Nutile Field Master Plan
5. Packer-Ellis Tennis Courts Phase III
6. Public Park Tree Canopy Improvements
7. Town Hall Auditorium Seating
8. Tri-Community Greenway Improvements

Or take any other action in relation thereto.

(Winchester Committee on Community Preservation)

MOTION #1: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $145,500 from the Community Preservation Open Space and Recreation Reserve and $154,500 from the Community Preservation Annual Budgeted Reserve, for the purpose of upgrading and restoring the former bathhouse site and constructing a new community pavilion at Leonard Field, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #1: *The Friends of Winchester Recreation, in partnership with Winchester Recreation and the Department of Public Works, seeks to complete the final phase of the Leonard Playground Master Plan through the restoration of the former bathhouse site and construction of a new community pavilion at Leonard Field.*

The remaining bathhouse structure is the last unfinished component of the Leonard Field revitalization effort. Originally constructed to support the former swimming area at Leonard Pond, the structure no longer serves a functional purpose and detracts from the appearance, safety, and usability of one of Winchester's most heavily utilized recreational assets. Its removal and replacement will improve safety, enhance accessibility, create shaded gathering space, complete a community-supported master plan initiative, and increase the long-term value of a significant public recreation resource.

The project scope includes demolishing and removing the remaining bathhouse structure; site grading and utility improvements; construction of a prefabricated community pavilion and foundation; installation of an architecturally compatible restroom screening structure; and associated engineering, landscape architecture, and construction oversight services.

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #2: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $35,000 from the Community Preservation Annual Budgeted Reserve, for the purpose of installing a new shade structure at Lincoln Elementary School, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #2*: The Lincoln Elementary School is located at 161 Mystic Valley Parkway near the historic downtown area of Winchester. The Lincoln School Parents Association, in partnership with the School Committee and Winchester Public Schools, seeks to install two permanent 16-foot by 16-foot commercial-grade cantilever shade structures with 10-foot entry height and quick-release fabric*

canopies at Lincoln Elementary School. Together, the structures will provide approximately 512 square feet of dedicated shaded outdoor space for students, families, and community members.

Lincoln's playground, field, and outdoor gathering spaces are used daily by students during the school day and by Winchester residents during evenings, weekends, school vacations, and summer months. The proposed shade structures will improve the comfort, accessibility, and usability of these public recreational spaces while supporting outdoor play, learning, recreation, and community use. The structures will also provide important public health benefits by reducing exposure to harmful ultraviolet (UV) radiation and excessive heat. The structures are necessary to replace the loss of a beloved mature shade tree in 2025 that had provided one of the campus's primary sources of natural shade.

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #3: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $35,000 from the Community Preservation Annual Budgeted Reserve, for the purpose of restoring and resurfacing the tennis courts at McDonald Field, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #3*: Winchester Recreation proposes to restore and extend the life of the McDonald tennis courts through comprehensive crack repair, surface rehabilitation, acrylic resurfacing, restriping, and installation of new tennis nets and posts. This project will preserve one of Winchester's most heavily utilized public tennis facilities and protect one of only three municipal hard court tennis court locations available to residents. The proposed improvements will restore court functionality, improve user safety, extend the useful life of the facility, and protect the Town's original capital investment while avoiding substantially greater reconstruction costs in the future.*

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #4: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $50,000 from the Community Preservation Annual Budgeted Reserve, for the purpose of creating a Master Plan for Nutile Field, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #4*: Nutile Field is one of Winchester's most heavily used recreation facilities. The field serves hundreds of Winchester children and families each year for baseball, softball, clinics, practices, games, and tournaments. Working with Winchester Recreation and the Town Manager's Office, Winchester Youth Softball and Baseball seeks a comprehensive capital investment into Nutile Field, including replacing aging fencing, backstops, and dugouts on fields and improving the adjacent parking area to support safer circulation and accessible parking. The Master Plan will create a long-term, strategic blueprint for that work.*

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #5: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $400,000 from the Community Preservation Annual Budgeted Reserve, for the purpose of final design, permitting, and construction readiness work for the Packer-Ellis Tennis Courts Restoration Project, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #5*: With this appropriation, Winchester Recreation will complete all remaining engineering, design, permitting, bidding, and construction preparation activities necessary to position the Town of Winchester for the full restoration and long-term preservation of the historic Packer-Ellis Tennis Courts. This phase will culminate in a fully engineered, permitted, and bid-ready project. Constructed in approximately 1922, the Packer-Ellis Tennis Courts are now more than 103 years old and represent one of the largest municipal clay court facilities in the United States. The facility is a unique recreational and historic asset that serves residents of all ages and skill levels while preserving a recreational resource that has been a part of Winchester's community fabric for over a century.*

Phases I and II of the Packer-Ellis Restoration Project developed a concept for a site-wide renovation, and develop a conceptual plan including structural engineering, storm water runoff, utilities, building in the flood zone, and addressing additional issues in collaboration with DPW, Engineering, Building, and Conservation departments. Completion of Phase III will provide the Town with final engineered construction documents, regulatory permitting approvals, stormwater management design compliant with current standards, pedestrian and parking improvements, updated construction cost estimates, bid-ready procurement documents, and a clear implementation roadmap for construction. By completing these tasks in advance of construction, the Town will reduce project risk, improve cost certainty, and place itself in a strong position to pursue grants, future CPA funding, private fundraising, and other funding opportunities for implementation.

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #6: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $60,000 from the Community Preservation Open Space and Recreation Reserve, for the purpose of implementing public park tree canopy improvements throughout the town, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #6*: The Permanent Street Tree Committee, with the support of the Town Manager's Office, proposes to undertake a focused tree planting and canopy improvement project to install up to 50 trees in four park/recreation areas throughout town.*

Winchester is fortunate to have beautifully treed neighborhoods, streets, and parks. However, the town has no coordinated plan or budget to track and manage trees. This stands in sharp contrast to neighboring towns such as Lexington, Melrose, and Arlington, which have dedicated resources and coordinated tree management plans. The project is an opportunity to demonstrate the benefits of trees for open space, recreation, and historical character, and to realize those benefits by installing trees. As the Tree Committee revealed in 2025, Winchester has experienced a net tree canopy loss since 2012. And yet, our town bylaws recognize "that mature trees have aesthetic appeal, contribute to the distinct character of certain neighborhoods, improve air quality, provide glare and heat protection, reduce noise, aid in the stabilization of soil, provide natural flood and climate control, create habitats for wildlife, provide traffic calming, enhance property values and provide natural privacy to neighbors." [Ch. 18-1]

Public parks such as Davidson Park, Elliot Park, Ginn Field, and McDonald Field are vital recreational assets for the town of Winchester. However, natural canopy loss from storms and aging tree stocks, and a lack of recent plantings has left portions of community spaces exposed, reducing their aesthetic appeal and recreational utility during peak summer months.

The project will undertake careful planning and planting of new trees at community spaces around town. The PSTC anticipates completing plantings at Davidson Park, Elliot Park, Ginn Field, and McDonald Field, subject to further site assessment and planning and alignment with project partners. The multi-park scope for this project will ensure that the project's benefits are spread across town to a range of recreational users from different neighborhoods. Each of these spaces has unique needs and

opportunities, and there is no cohesive plan for the health of their tree canopies. The project will help establish a comprehensive baseline vision for trees in these spaces and make measurable progress toward that vision by installing trees.

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #7: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $25,000 from the Community Preservation Historic Resources Reserve, for the purpose of restoring the seating area in the Town Hall auditorium balcony, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #7*: The historic auditorium in the Winchester Town Hall is one of the town's most significant civic spaces and has been at the heart of community life for nearly 140 years. For generations of Winchester residents, the Maurer Auditorium has been where the town comes together, whether for Town Meeting debates, school performances, charity events, concerts, or civic celebrations. The historic Winchester Town Hall was listed on the National Register of Historic Places on March 31, 1983. The building was recognized for its architectural significance as a prominent example of late-19th-century civic architecture, combining Romanesque Revival and Queen Anne design elements. With this appropriation, the Department of Public Works will replace the seat backs and seat cushions for the balcony seating.*

Majority Vote Required

MOTION #8: MOVED AND SECONDED that the Town vote to appropriate and transfer from the Community Preservation Fund, pursuant to G.L. c. 44B, § 5, the sum of $15,500 from the Community Preservation Annual Budgeted Reserve, for the purpose of implementing improvements to the Tri-Community Greenway, including necessary costs and expenses related thereto, as recommended by the Winchester Committee on Community Preservation.

BACKGROUND #8*: The Tri-Community Greenway is a recreational, historical and practical asset which opened in 2019. Not only is the Greenway itself a recreational asset for walking and biking, it also connects playgrounds, playing fields, open space and waterbodies from the Mystic River Reservation to Horn Pond in Woburn and Recreation Park in Stoneham. Within Winchester the Greenway connects from Shannon Beach through Ginn Field, the McCall field, the banks of the Aberjona River. the Mill Pond, Junkins Pond, Ciarcia (Skillings) Field, the Muraco Playground Leonard Pond and Leonard Field and Davidson Park including abutting, soon-to-be acquired Conservation Land North East of Washington Street. The Greenway is also a historical asset tracing the development of water resources along the Aberjona, rail transportation development and parts of Middlesex Canal. Additionally, the Greenway is used as an affordable, low pollution, and safer route to school, work and shopping destinations by pedestrians and bicyclists.*

Walk and Roll Winchester, working with the Town Manager's Office, seeks to implement six small projects to enhance the recreational experience and historical learning experience of Winchester residents on the Tri-community Greenway by increasing the safety and comfort of users. These small capital improvements will also reduce future maintenance and snow and ice expenses. The projects are: (1) installing plowing guideposts at Wedgemere, Ginn, Leonard, and Davison Parks, (2) painting crosswalks at Swanton Street and the Muraco School parking lot, (3) improving the Ginn Field pedestrian and bike routes through the Ginn parking lot, (4) removing steel bollards and installing barrels at Ginn Field and Muraco School; (5) improvements to the Mill Pond Dam viewing area; and (6) paving aprons along the Mt. Vernon bridge, Skilling Crossing, and Cross Street intersections.

Majority Vote Required